significantly improved the work process. First, this presence enabled the two bodies, MI and the Mossad, to work in real time, twenty-four hours a day, every day. Second, the Mossad revealed all of the secrets behind its work—both intelligence and operational—to the Military Intelligence representative so that, through him, the top echelons of MI could better understand and appreciate the intelligence product provided by the Mossad. Third, the exposure enabled MI, through its representative at the Mossad, to focus its briefings on the individual source and its identified potential.

The development of the direction of intelligence collection was further enhanced when Military Intelligence's research department requested that its analysts be included in the meetings in which sources were debriefed, and the Mossad agreed. In retrospect, to the best of my judgment, at this stage the system began to "fake it." Why do I say this? The answer requires a slightly lengthy explanation, which is related to the ethos of HUMINT in the Mossad, which I experienced during the first decade of my service. HUMINT is like the "aircraft carrier" of the intelligence professions, first of all because of its historical age, which had its beginnings in the era of Joseph and his brothers in Genesis, but no less because of HUMINT's advantage over the other intelligence disciplines. This advantage is expressed in the fact that an intelligence collection officer, who is also an intelligence officer by training, can engage in live dialogue with his or her sources. In all of the other disciplines of intelligence—COMINT (communications intelligence), SIGINT (signals intelligence), VISINT (visual intelligence), and OSINT (open-source intelligence)—the intelligence officer can receive a piece of intelligence on a particular subject at a particular place at a particular time but cannot pose questions. The live dialogue between the collection officer and his or her source is the best way to gather intelligence on the enemy's intentions.

The classic ethos of the Mossad intelligence-gathering officer is that of someone who knows how to recruit sources, how to control them, and how to debrief them. I will allow myself to trust the opinion of my commanders, who considered me to be such an officer. MI's request to the Mossad that its researchers be integrated with the Mossad's collection officers was accepted by the Mossad as innocent and professional, since the addition of an intelligence researcher to the debriefing of a source should ensure a higher-quality intelligence outcome. In fact, the Mossad became a kind of a travel agency for MI researchers, for whom traveling abroad for a few days (during